UPSC INDIAN POLITY

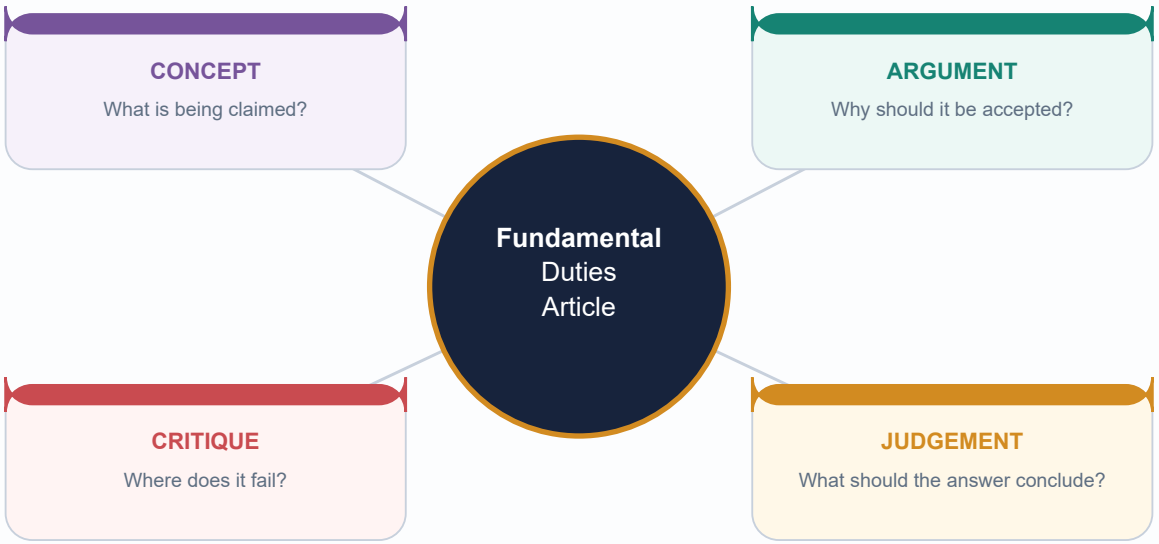
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE Deep-Learning Visual Notes

Indian Polity · GS Paper II · Prelims + Mains

Layer 1: Basic foundation · Layer 2: Advanced constitutional and exam depth

Sources: Fundamental-Duties.md + 09_Fundamental-Duties.md

Learning cards: 34



Facts from official sources | Inferences clearly marked | No fabricated data

HIGH UPSC RELEVANCE

HIGH

Foundation · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Basic (foundation) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Basic (foundation) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Part IV-A, Article 51A)
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs	

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant (Part IV-A, Article 51A)

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / standard knowledge · □ = current affairs

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Foundation · Snapshot

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Item	Detail
Part of Constitution	□ Part IV-A (single Article — **51A**)
Borrowed from	□ **USSR** (erstwhile Soviet Constitution)
Added by	□ **42nd Amendment, 1976** (10 duties)
11th duty added by	□ **86th Amendment, 2002** (education 6–14)
Recommended by	□ **Swaran Singh Committee (1976)**
Nature	□ **Non-justiciable, citizens only**
Count today	□ **11**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Snapshot

HIGH

Foundation · Core idea

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ FDs remind citizens that alongside rights they owe **duties** to the country, society and fellow citizens. Added after the internal Emergency (1975–77). They are **moral & civic** obligations — not enforceable by courts, but Parliament **may** legislate to enforce them.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. FDs remind citizens that alongside rights they owe **duties** to the country, society and fellow citizens. Added after the internal Emergency (1975–77). They are **moral & civic** obligations — not enforceable by courts, but Parliament **may** legislate to enforce them.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core idea

HIGH

Foundation · The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

	Duty (keyword)
a	Respect **Constitution, Flag, Anthem**
b	Cherish **freedom-struggle ideals**
c	Protect **sovereignty, unity, integrity**
d	**Defend the country** / national service
e	Promote **harmony**; dignity of women
f	Preserve **composite culture**
g	Protect **environment** & wildlife
h	Develop **scientific temper**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form

HIGH

Foundation · The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

	Duty (keyword)
i	Safeguard **public property**; abjure violence
j	Strive for **excellence**
k	Provide **education** to child (6–14) — **86th Amdt**

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form

HIGH

Foundation · The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Mnemonic: the **11th duty (education 6–14)** links with **Art 21A** & **Art 45** — all from the

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **86th Amendment, 2002**.

MEMORY HOOK

Mnemonic: the 11th duty (education 6–14) links with Art 21A & Art 45 — all from the

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → The 11 Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — keyword form

HIGH

Foundation · Key features

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Mix of **moral** (noble ideals) and **civic** (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

KEY FEATURES: RECALL MAP

Key features

V

Dimension 1 Mix of moral (noble ideals) and civic (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.	**Dimension 2** Apply to citizens only (not foreigners).
Dimension 3 Non-justiciable — no direct court enforcement.	**Dimension 4** Swaran Singh Committee recommended 8; 42nd Amdt added 10; 86th Amdt made it 11.

STATIC THEORY

- Apply to **citizens only** (not foreigners).

- **Non-justiciable** — no direct court enforcement.

- Swaran Singh Committee recommended **8**; 42nd Amdt added **10**; 86th Amdt made it **11**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Mix of **moral** (noble ideals) and **civic** (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.
2. Apply to **citizens only** (not foreigners).
3. **Non-justiciable** — no direct court enforcement.
4. Swaran Singh Committee recommended **8**; 42nd Amdt added **10**; 86th Amdt made it **11**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Key features

HIGH

Foundation · Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ FDs = **Part IV-A, Article 51A**; borrowed from **USSR**.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS (PRELIMS): RECALL MAP

Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

V

Dimension 1 □ FDs = Part IV-A, Article 51A; borrowed from USSR.	**Dimension 2** □ 42nd Amdt (1976) added them; 86th Amdt (2002) added the 11th (education).
Dimension 3 □ Swaran Singh Committee (1976) recommended FDs.	**Dimension 4** □ Duties to pay taxes / vote are NOT Fundamental Duties.

STATIC THEORY

- □ **42nd Amdt (1976)** added them; **86th Amdt (2002)** added the 11th (education).
- □ **Swaran Singh Committee** (1976) recommended FDs.
- □ Duties to **pay taxes / vote** are **NOT** Fundamental Duties.
- □ **Non-justiciable** and for **citizens only**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. FDs = **Part IV-A, Article 51A**; borrowed from **USSR**.
2. **42nd Amdt (1976)** added them; **86th Amdt (2002)** added the 11th (education).
3. **Swaran Singh Committee** (1976) recommended FDs.
4. Duties to **pay taxes / vote** are **NOT** Fundamental Duties.
5. **Non-justiciable** and for **citizens only**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Must-Know Facts (Prelims)

HIGH

Foundation · □ Current link

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Current legal control (28 August 2026):** *Durga Dutt v. Union of India*, W.P.(C) 67/2022, remains pending. The Supreme Court's written order dated 11 September 2024 asked the Attorney General for a synopsis of Central and State enactments effectuating Article 51A and relisted the matter. Reported separation-of-powers observations at the hearing are not a final ratio. The stable implementation lesson comes from the **Verma Committee (1999)**: constitutional education, awareness and effective use of precise existing laws. □□ The Swaran Singh recommendations that were rejected, the Verma Committee's list of enforcing laws, the criticism, the significance, the traps and the Mains angles are all held **in this file**. *Advanced: optional deeper detail in advanced/09_Fundamental-Duties.md — not required for any mark.*

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of □ Current link.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ Current link

HIGH

Foundation · Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

*Purpose: Fundamental Duties questions turn on **status** (non-justiciable yet constitutionally weighted) and on the **rights–duties balance**. This section promotes the origin, criticism, interpretive use and the Verma Committee evidence so the Basic file can answer a GS-II demand without the Advanced companion. This file carries no routed objective PYQ blocks; the standard confusion pairs are covered in §7.6.*

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Answer architecture (10/15/20-mark support)

HIGH

Foundation · 7.1 Demand and directive map

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Demand family	Typical directive signals	Answer spine to use
Status & justiciability	"Non-justiciable yet significant — discuss"	Art 51A text → non-enforceability → interpretive/reasonableness use → verdict
Rights–duties balance	"Two wheels of the same chariot — evaluate"	Origin (post-Emergency) → complementarity with FR/DPSP → limits → verdict
Should FDs be justiciable	"Examine the case for enforcing FDs"	Verma Committee's existing laws → pending *Durga Dutt* institutional caution → awareness vs coercion → verdict
Specific duty in action	"Art 51A(g) and environmental protection"	The duty → its statutory backing → read with a FR/DPSP → limit
Reform of FDs	"Are FDs adequate?"	Non-exhaustive list → omitted duties (tax/vote) → criticism → verdict

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.1 Demand and directive map

HIGH

Foundation · 7.2 Qualified thesis options

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Fundamental Duties are constitutionally weighted moral obligations, not enforceable commands: their significance lies in shaping citizen conduct and in aiding statutory interpretation, not in judicial coercion.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.2 QUALIFIED THESIS OPTIONS: RECALL MAP

7.2 Qualified thesis options

V

Dimension 1 Fundamental Duties are constitutionally weighted moral obligations, not enforceable commands: their significance lies in shaping citizen conduct and i	**Dimension 2** The 42nd Amendment answered a real gap — a Constitution of rights with no reciprocal duties — but placing Part IV-A after the Directive Principles lef
Dimension 3 The right way to operationalise FDs is through the precise laws and civic-education measures the Verma Committee mapped; pending Durga Dutt proceeding	**Dimension 4** Duties and rights are two wheels of the same chariot: FDs supply the citizen-side discipline that makes the rights framework sustainable, which is why

STATIC THEORY

- The 42nd Amendment answered a real gap — a Constitution of rights with no reciprocal duties — but placing Part IV-A after the Directive Principles left duties looking subordinate to both rights and directives.

- The right way to operationalise FDs is through the precise laws and civic-education measures the Verma Committee mapped; pending Durga Dutt *proceedings must not be presented as a final judicial command or holding.*

- Duties and rights are two wheels of the same chariot: FDs supply the citizen-side discipline that makes the rights framework sustainable, which is why even the government that reversed much of the 42nd Amendment retained them.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.2 Qualified thesis options

HIGH

Foundation · 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Marks	Architecture	Evidence load
10	Thesis → origin & status → one significance + one criticism → verdict	2–3 units, incl. Swaran Singh / 42nd–86th Amdt
15	Thesis → origin → status & interpretive use → criticism → enforcement debate → graded verdict	4–6 units incl. Verma Committee + *Durga Dutt*
20	Thesis → constitutional design → list & classification → significance → criticism/variation → justiciability debate → verdict	6–8 units across status + reform

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.3 Mark-scaled structures

HIGH

Foundation · 7.4 Bank A — Origin, list and status

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the foundation source layer.

KEY DATA

Claim	Named provision / source	Mechanism / significance	Limitation / caution
FDs were a deliberate post-Emergency addition	□ **Swaran Singh Committee (1976)**; **42nd Amendment, 1976** inserted **Part IV-A / Art 51A**	Added citizen duties absent in the original Constitution; inspired by the erstwhile **USSR**	The Committee recommended **8**; the 42nd Amdt actually included **10**
The list grew to eleven	□ **86th Amendment, 2002** added **Art 51A(k)** (parent/guardian to provide education, ages 6–14)	Pairs with Art 21A and Art 45 (the education trio)	**Count today = 11**, not 10
FDs are non-justiciable but not inert	□ Art 51A; □□ SC (1992) — a law giving effect to a FD may be deemed "reasonable" under Art 14/19	No direct court enforcement, but duties aid statutory interpretation and support reasonable restrictions; Parliament may legislate to enforce	They confer no enforceable right; confined to **citizens only**
Some FDs already have legal backing	□ **Verma Committee (1999)** identified existing enforcing laws	e.g. Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act 1971; Protection of Civil Rights Act 1955; UAPA 1967; RP Act 1951; Wildlife (Protection) Act 1972	The Committee **identified existing laws** — it did not add new duties
Rejected recommendations recur in exams	□ Swaran Singh recommendations **not accepted**	(1) penalty for non-compliance; (2) such penalty laws non-questionable in court; (3) a duty to **pay taxes**	These were recommended but **left out** of Art 51A

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.4 Bank A — Origin, list and status

HIGH

Foundation · 7.5 Mechanism, incentives, criticism and current status

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Mechanism:** FDs operate through moral/civic obligation and through **interpretive weight** — courts read them alongside FRs and DPSP (notably **Art 51A(g)** with **Art 21** in environmental cases), and Parliament may legislate to give them teeth. □□ **Incentive/consequence:** because they are unenforceable, compliance depends on civic culture; their main institutional effect is to legitimise reasonable restrictions on rights and to guide public conduct. □ **Criticism (5):** non-exhaustive (omits paying taxes, voting, family planning); vague ("noble ideals", "composite culture", "scientific temper"); a mere code of moral precepts; superfluous; **wrongly placed after Part IV**, signalling subordination to FRs.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□□ **Counter-argument:** the eventual **consensus** — the Janata government that reversed much of the 42nd Amendment via the 43rd/44th Amendments **retained** the FDs, and the 2002 addition reinforced them.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.5 MECHANISM, INCENTIVES, CRITICISM AND CURRENT STATUS: RECALL MAP

7.5 Mechanism, incentives, criticism and current status

V

Dimension 1 □□ Counter-argument: the eventual consensus — the Janata government that reversed much of the 42nd Amendment via the 43rd/44th Amendments retained the	**Dimension 2** □ Current status (as of 28 August 2026): Durga Dutt v. Union of India,
Dimension 3 W.P.(C) 67/2022, remains pending. The written order of 11 September 2024 requested a synopsis of Central and State enactments effectuating Article 51A	

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Current status (as of 28 August 2026): _Durga Dutt v. Union of India_**,

- W.P.(C) 67/2022, remains pending. The written order of **11 September 2024** requested a synopsis of Central and State enactments effectuating Article 51A and relisted the matter. Do not convert reported oral observations into a final holding.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.5 Mechanism, incentives, criticism and current status

HIGH

Foundation · 7.6 Prelims close-option distinctions and verdict scaffolds · Part 1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

This file carries no routed objective PYQ blocks. Standard confusion pairs:

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.6 PRELIMS CLOSE-OPTION DISTINCTIONS AND VERDICT SCAFFOLDS: RECALL MAP

7.6 Prelims close-option distinctions and verdict scaffolds

V

Dimension 1 This file carries no routed objective PYQ blocks. Standard confusion pairs:	**Dimension 2** □ Count: there are 11 Fundamental Duties (86th Amdt 2002 added the 11th) — not 10.
Dimension 3 □ Swaran Singh vs enacted: the Committee recommended 8; the 42nd Amendment included 10.	**Dimension 4** □ Which amendment: 42nd Amendment (1976) added FDs; 86th Amendment (2002) added Art 51A(k).

STATIC THEORY

- □ **Count:** there are **11** Fundamental Duties (86th Amdt 2002 added the 11th) — not 10.
- □ **Swaran Singh vs enacted:** the Committee recommended **8**; the 42nd Amendment included **10**.
- □ **Which amendment:** 42nd Amendment (1976) added FDs; 86th Amendment (2002) added Art 51A(k).
- □ **Source:** the erstwhile **USSR** — not the USA; **Japan** is the only other notable democracy that lists citizens' duties.
- □ **Scope:** FDs apply to **citizens only** (unlike some FRs which extend to all persons) and are **non-justiciable**.
- □ **Not FDs:** the duty to **pay taxes** and to **vote** are **not** Fundamental Duties (the tax duty was only *recommended*).

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. **Count:** there are **11** Fundamental Duties (86th Amdt 2002 added the 11th) — not 10.
2. **Swaran Singh vs enacted:** the Committee recommended **8**; the 42nd Amendment included **10**.
3. **Which amendment:** 42nd Amendment (1976) added FDs; 86th Amendment (2002) added Art 51A(k).
4. **Source:** the erstwhile **USSR** — not the USA; **Japan** is the only other notable democracy that lists citizens' duties.
5. **Scope:** FDs apply to **citizens only** (unlike some FRs which extend to all persons) and are **non-justiciable**.
6. **Not FDs:** the duty to **pay taxes** and to **vote** are **not** Fundamental Duties (the tax duty was only *recommended*).

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.6 Prelims close-option distinctions and verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 7.6 Prelims close-option distinctions and verdict scaffolds · Part 2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Verdict scaffolds:

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Status demands:** □□ *FDs are constitutionally weighted but judicially unenforceable; their value is civic and interpretive, and demanding judicial enforcement mistakes their design.*
- **Rights–duties balance demands:** □□ *Duties complete the citizenship the rights create; the post-Emergency addition and its cross-party retention show a settled consensus that rights and duties are two wheels of one chariot.*
- **Justiciability-reform demands:** □□ *The realistic route is the Verma Committee's existing
- statutes plus civic awareness; pending *Durga Dutt* proceedings supply an institutional caution, not a final merits rule.*

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.6 Prelims close-option distinctions and verdict scaffolds

HIGH

Foundation · 7.7 Factual-risk and current-status controls

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

Do **not** state there are 10 Fundamental Duties — there are **11** since the **86th Amendment, 2002** (Art 51A(k)). Do **not** state the Swaran Singh Committee recommended 10 — it recommended **8**; the 42nd Amendment included **10**. Do **not** state FDs are justiciable — they are **non-justiciable** (though Parliament may legislate and courts may use them interpretively).

INTRO & ORIGIN

Do **not** state the duty to pay taxes or to vote is a Fundamental Duty — neither is included (the tax duty was only recommended).

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

7.7 FACTUAL-RISK AND CURRENT-STATUS CONTROLS: RECALL MAP

7.7 Factual-risk and current-status controls

V

Dimension 1 Do not state the duty to pay taxes or to vote is a Fundamental Duty — neither is included (the tax duty was only recommended).	**Dimension 2** Do not state FDs apply to all persons — they apply to citizens only.
Dimension 3 Do not state FDs were borrowed from the USA or Japan — they are inspired by the erstwhile USSR.	**Dimension 4** Do not state the Verma Committee added new duties — it identified existing laws enforcing some duties.

STATIC THEORY

- Do **not** state FDs apply to all persons — they apply to **citizens only**.

- Do **not** state FDs were borrowed from the USA or Japan — they are inspired by the erstwhile **USSR**.

- Do **not** state the Verma Committee added new duties — it **identified existing laws** enforcing some duties.

- □ Cite **_Durga Dutt_**, W.P.(C) 67/2022, as **pending** and use the written order dated

- **11 September 2024**; do not turn oral hearing observations into a final ratio.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → 7.7 Factual-risk and current-status controls

HIGH

Foundation · Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control.

Foundation learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Origin and placement: *the original Constitution had no separate citizen-duty list. The Swaran Singh Committee recommended eight duties; the 42nd Amendment, 1976 inserted Part IVA and ten clauses in Article 51A; the 86th Amendment, 2002 inserted clause (k), bringing the total to eleven.* ***Exact clauses:*** *preserve the constitutional wording and scope of clauses (a)-(k): Constitution/institutions/Flag/Anthem; freedom-struggle ideals; sovereignty-unity-integrity; defence/service; harmony and women's dignity; composite culture; environment/compassion; scientific temper/humanism/inquiry/ reform; public property/non-violence; excellence; and education opportunity by a parent or guardian for a child or ward aged six to fourteen.* ***Legal character:*** *duties apply to citizens only, are non-justiciable and are not self-executing offences. Parliament or a competent legislature may enact a precise law; its validity remains subject to Fundamental Rights, competence and proportionality.* ***Case-law discipline:*** *Bijoe Emmanuel protects conscientious non-singing where no disrespect occurs; M.C. Mehta supports environmental education; AIIMS Students' Union recognises interpretive value; Naveen Jindal protects respectful flag display; A. Nagaraja and the 2023 Jallikattu judgment must retain their different statutory/constitutional outcomes.* ***Operationalisation:*** *the J.S. Verma Committee (1999) mapped existing laws and education/awareness measures. The National Honour Act, UAPA, BNS, environmental, public-property and education statutes create their own offences or duties; Article 51A alone does not.* ***Current status:*** *Durga Dutt, W.P.(C) 67/2022, remains pending on the located official record. The 11 September 2024 order sought a synopsis of Central and State laws effectuating Article 51A and did not make duties enforceable.* ***Four-ledger hostile audit:*** *exact text, committee/amendment history, legal mechanisms, cases, criticisms, omitted-duty traps, implementation and every routed or supporting 2018-2026 PYQ were checked.* ***PYQ boundary:*** *no direct routed objective or Mains question is invented. Relevant 2020 and 2025 questions remain explicitly supporting cross-topic routes.*

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Semantic-completeness ownership and PYQ control

HIGH

Advanced · Core Foundation

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Subject: Polity · **Tier:** Advanced (exam depth) · **GS Paper:** GS-II

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

CORE FOUNDATION: RECALL MAP

Core Foundation

V

Dimension 1 Subject: Polity · Tier: Advanced (exam depth) · GS Paper: GS-II	**Dimension 2** Grounded in: Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Part IV-A (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official court update.
Dimension 3 □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = official/court-verified update.	**Dimension 4** Companion: basic/Fundamental-Duties.md.

STATIC THEORY

- **Grounded in:** Indian Polity by M. Laxmikant, Part IV-A (direct check of the local Sixth Revised Edition PDF) + official court update.

- □ = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = official/court-verified update.

- *Companion: basic/Fundamental-Duties.md.*

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. = from source book · □□ = inference / case law · □ = official/court-verified update.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Core Foundation

HIGH

Advanced · Origin & source

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Original Constitution had **only rights, no duties**. Fundamental Duties (FDs) added in **1976**; one more added in **2002**. Inspired by the **Constitution of the erstwhile USSR**. □ None of the major democracies (USA, Canada, France, Germany, Australia) list citizens' duties; **Japan** is perhaps the only democratic constitution that does. Socialist states gave rights & duties equal weight.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- □ Placed in **Part IV-A**, a **single Article — 51A**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Original Constitution had **only rights, no duties**. Fundamental Duties (FDs) added in **1976**; one more added in **2002**. Inspired by the **Constitution of the erstwhile USSR**. None of the major democracies (USA, Canada, France, Germany, Australia) list citizens' duties; **Japan** is perhaps the only democratic constitution that does. Socialist states gave rights & duties equal weight.

2. Placed in **Part IV-A**, a **single Article — 51A**.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Origin & source

HIGH

Advanced · Swaran Singh Committee (1976)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Set up by the **Congress government in 1976** — need felt during the **internal Emergency (1975–77)**. Recommended a **separate chapter** on FDs. Govt accepted → enacted **42nd Amendment Act, 1976**, adding **Part IV-A / Art 51A** with **ten** duties.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

SWARAN SINGH COMMITTEE (1976): RECALL MAP

Swaran Singh Committee (1976)

V

Dimension 1 Set up by the Congress government in 1976 — need felt during the internal Emergency (1975–77). Recommended a separate chapter on FDs. Govt accepted	**Dimension 2** Key nuance: Committee suggested eight duties → 42nd Amdt actually included ten.
Dimension 3 Committee recommendations NOT accepted (high PYQ value):	**Dimension 4** Parliament may impose penalty/punishment for non-compliance.

STATIC THEORY

- Key nuance: Committee suggested **eight** duties → 42nd Amdt actually included **ten**.

- **Committee recommendations NOT accepted** (high PYQ value):

- Parliament may impose **penalty/punishment** for non-compliance.

- Such penalty laws **not questionable** in courts (no FR/other-provision challenge).

- **Duty to pay taxes** should be a Fundamental Duty.

MEMORY HOOK

Key nuance: Committee suggested eight duties → 42nd Amdt actually included ten.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Set up by the **Congress government in 1976** — need felt during the **internal Emergency (1975–77)**. Recommended a **separate chapter** on FDs. Govt accepted → enacted **42nd Amendment Act, 1976**, adding **Part IV-A / Art 51A** with **ten** duties.

2. Committee recommendations NOT accepted (high PYQ value):

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Swaran Singh Committee (1976)

HIGH

Advanced · List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11 · Table 1.1

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

	Duty	Type
(a)	Abide by Constitution; respect its ideals, institutions, **National Flag & National Anthem**	civic
(b)	Cherish & follow **noble ideals of the freedom struggle**	moral
(c)	Uphold & protect **sovereignty, unity & integrity** of India	civic
(d)	**Defend the country** & render national service when called	civic
(e)	Promote **harmony & common brotherhood** beyond religion/language/region; **renounce practices derogatory to dignity of women**	moral
(f)	Value & preserve rich heritage of **composite culture**	moral
(g)	Protect & improve **natural environment** (forests, lakes, rivers, wildlife); compassion for living creatures	civic
(h)	Develop **scientific temper**, humanism, spirit of inquiry & reform	moral

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK
Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11

HIGH

Advanced · List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11 · Table 1.2

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

	Duty	Type
(i)	Safeguard **public property**; abjure violence	civic
(j)	Strive towards **excellence** in individual & collective activity	moral
(k)	Provide **education** to one's child/ward aged **6–14** — □ added by **86th Amendment, 2002**	civic

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11

HIGH

Advanced · List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ It shall be the duty of every citizen of India:

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

LIST OF FUNDAMENTAL DUTIES (ART 51A) — ALL 11: RECALL MAP

List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11

V

Dimension 1 □ It shall be the duty of every citizen of India:	**Dimension 2** □ Mnemonic (11th duty): "86th → education 6–14" pairs with Art 21A & Art 45 — the
Dimension 3 education-trio all trace to the 86th Amendment.	

STATIC THEORY

- □ Mnemonic (11th duty): "**86th → education 6–14**" pairs with **Art 21A** & **Art 45** — the

- education-trio all trace to the 86th Amendment.

MEMORY HOOK

Mnemonic (11th duty): "86th → education 6–14" pairs with Art 21A & Art 45 — the

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. It shall be the duty of every citizen of India:

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → List of Fundamental Duties (Art 51A) — all 11

HIGH

Advanced · Features (4)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 Mix of **moral** (noble ideals) & **civic** (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

FEATURES (4): RECALL MAP

Features (4)

V

Dimension 1 Mix of moral (noble ideals) & civic (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.	**Dimension 2** Codify values integral to Indian tradition & way of life.
Dimension 3 Confined to citizens only — do not extend to foreigners (unlike some FRs).	**Dimension 4** Non-justiciable — no direct court enforcement, no legal sanction; but Parliament may

STATIC THEORY

- Codify values integral to Indian tradition & way of life.

- Confined to **citizens only** — do **not** extend to foreigners (unlike some FRs).

- **Non-justiciable** — no direct court enforcement, no legal sanction; **but Parliament may

- enforce by suitable legislation**.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Mix of **moral** (noble ideals) & **civic** (respect Flag/Anthem) duties.

2. Codify values integral to Indian tradition & way of life.

3. Confined to **citizens only** — do **not** extend to foreigners (unlike some FRs).

4. Non-justiciable — no direct court enforcement, no legal sanction; **but Parliament may

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Features (4)

HIGH

Advanced · Criticism (5)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 (1) **Not exhaustive** — omits casting vote, paying taxes, family planning (tax duty was even recommended by Swaran Singh). (2) **Vague/ambiguous** — "noble ideals," "composite culture," "scientific temper" hard for common man. (3) **Code of moral precepts** (non-justiciable). (4) **Superfluous** — people would perform them anyway. (5) **Wrongly placed** — appended after Part IV (DPSP); should have followed Part III to be on par with FRs.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. (1) **Not exhaustive** — omits casting vote, paying taxes, family planning (tax duty was even recommended by Swaran Singh). (2) **Vague/ambiguous** — "noble ideals," "composite culture," "scientific temper" hard for common man. (3) **Code of moral precepts** (non-justiciable). (4) **Superfluous** — people would perform them anyway. (5) **Wrongly placed** — appended after Part IV (DPSP); should have followed Part III to be on par with FRs.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Criticism (5)

HIGH

Advanced · Significance (5)

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

 (1) Reminder that rights carry duties. (2) Warning against anti-national/anti-social acts (flag burning, destroying public property). (3) Source of inspiration & discipline; citizens = active participants. (4) **Help courts judge constitutional validity** — SC (**1992**): a law giving effect to an FD may be deemed "reasonable" under **Art 14/19** and saved. (5) **Enforceable by law** — Parliament can provide penalties.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

STATIC THEORY

- **Political voices:** H.R. Gokhale (Law Min.) — FDs would have a "sobering effect on restless spirits"; Indira Gandhi — inclusion "strengthens democracy" / "democratic balance." Morarji Desai's Janata govt (which reversed much of the 42nd Amdt via **43rd & 44th Amdts**) did **not** annul FDs → eventual **consensus**, reinforced by the 2002 addition.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. (1) Reminder that rights carry duties. (2) Warning against anti-national/anti-social acts (flag burning, destroying public property). (3) Source of inspiration & discipline; citizens = active participants. (4) **Help courts judge constitutional validity** — SC (**1992**): a law giving effect to an FD may be deemed "reasonable" under **Art 14/19** and saved. (5) **Enforceable by law** — Parliament can provide penalties.

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MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Significance (5)

HIGH

Advanced · Verma Committee (1999) — existing legal provisions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Structured comparison from the advanced source layer.

KEY DATA

Law	Enforces which duty
□ **Prevention of Insults to National Honour Act, 1971**	respect to Constitution/Flag/Anthem
□ Various criminal laws	punish enmity between groups (language/race/religion)
□ **Protection of Civil Rights Act, 1955**	caste/religion offences
□ **Bharatiya Nyaya Sanhita, 2023** (IPC successor from 1 Jul 2024)	relevant offences affecting harmony/national integration
□ **Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act, 1967**	declare communal org unlawful
□ **Representation of People Act, 1951**	disqualify members for corrupt practice / soliciting votes on religion
□ **Wildlife (Protection) Act, 1972**	ban trade in endangered species
□ **Van (Sanrakshan Evam Samvardhan) Adhiniyam, 1980** (renamed 2023)	regulate diversion of forest land

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Verma Committee (1999) — existing legal provisions □

HIGH

Advanced · Verma Committee (1999) — existing legal provisions □

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Justice J.S. Verma Committee on **Operationalisation of FDs (1999)** identified laws already enforcing some FDs:

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MUST-KNOW FACTS

1. Justice J.S. Verma Committee on **Operationalisation of FDs (1999)** identified laws already enforcing some FDs:

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Verma Committee (1999) — existing legal provisions □

HIGH

Advanced · □ CURRENT AFFAIRS — Enforcement of FDs

GS-II Indian Polity

NEWS TRIGGER

□ **Current status (28 August 2026): Durga Dutt v. Union of India**, W.P.(C) 67/2022, remains pending. The written Supreme Court order dated **11 September 2024** requested the Attorney General to file a synopsis of Central and State enactments effectuating facets of Article 51A and relisted the matter. □ The written order did **not** make duties enforceable, dismiss the petition or announce a final ratio against legislative directions.

INTRO & ORIGIN

□ Reported separation-of-powers observations at the hearing remain oral observations. The

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

□ CURRENT AFFAIRS — ENFORCEMENT OF FDS: RECALL MAP

□ CURRENT AFFAIRS — Enforcement of FDs

V

Dimension 1 □ Reported separation-of-powers observations at the hearing remain oral observations. The	**Dimension 2** stable awareness-and-education route is independently supported by the Verma Committee.
Dimension 3 □ Art 51A(g) is repeatedly read with Art 21 in environmental jurisprudence;	**Dimension 4** the stable exam point is the rights-duties linkage, not an unverified one-line case label.

STATIC THEORY

- stable awareness-and-education route is independently supported by the **Verma Committee**.

- □ **Art 51A(g)** is repeatedly read with **Art 21** in environmental jurisprudence;

- the stable exam point is the rights-duties linkage, not an unverified one-line case label.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → □ CURRENT AFFAIRS — Enforcement of FDs

HIGH

Advanced · UPSC Traps

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of UPSC Traps.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

UPSC TRAPS

WRONG: FDs inspired by USA/Japan

CORRECT: USSR (Japan is only the notable *other* democracy that lists duties).

WRONG: Swaran Singh recommended 10

CORRECT: recommended **8**, but 42nd Amdt added **10**.

WRONG: There are 10 FDs

CORRECT: 11 (86th Amdt added the 11th in 2002).

WRONG: Duty to pay taxes / vote is a FD

CORRECT: not included (tax duty only *recommended*).

WRONG: FDs apply to all persons

CORRECT: citizens only.

WRONG: FDs are justiciable

CORRECT: non-justiciable (but Parliament may legislate).

WRONG: Verma Committee added new duties

CORRECT: it only **identified existing laws** enforcing them.

MAINS ANGLE

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → UPSC Traps

HIGH

Advanced · PYQ / CA anchors

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of PYQ / CA anchors.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

Recurrent Prelims: exact 11-duty wording; which amendment (42nd vs 86th); Swaran Singh 8-vs-10; rejected recommendations (tax/penalty). □ Recheck the Supreme Court docket before the exam; the verified anchor is the pending Durga Dutt docket and written order dated 11 September 2024.

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → PYQ / CA anchors

HIGH

Advanced · Mains angles

GS-II Indian Polity

INTRO & ORIGIN

Exam-ready treatment of Mains angles.

Advanced learning layer: concepts → constitutional detail → UPSC application.

MAINS ANGLE

"Rights and duties are two wheels of the same chariot" — evaluate the constitutional status of FDs. Should Fundamental Duties be made justiciable? (use Durga Dutt 2024 + Verma Committee). Role of FDs in nation-building & the environment (Art 51A(g) ↔ Art 21).

STUDY LINK

Fundamental Duties (Article 51A) — ADVANCED / COMPLETE → Mains angles

End of Register Notes - UPSC Agent / Copilot CLI